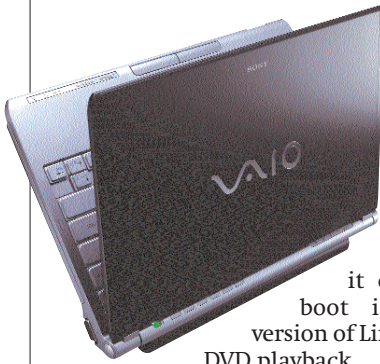




resilience, four times the rigidity, and one third the weight. While this thin wonder packs enough punch to run Windows XP Professional, it can also quickly boot into a stripped version of Linux for audio and DVD playback.

Toshiba Red Transformer

The Toshiba Red Transformer laptop, with its 17-inch flat screen, easily transforms from the utility of a laptop computer to the fun of a flat screen home entertainment centre. A unique sliding hinge attached to the back of the screen transforms the computer into entertainment mode by pushing the screen to the forefront. The screen rests on the integrated speaker panel and a removable remote control and keyboard allow the computer to be controlled from afar. In work mode, the keyboard is removable for wireless use. In entertainment mode, a remote control slides out of the aluminium housing and the speaker enclosure flips up to connect flush with the screen, creating a surface with video and sound oriented directly toward the viewer.



Nintendo's Wii

The Wii is an excellent game console that succeeds because it is not afraid to have fun. At the heart of this design masterpiece is a wireless controller, which detects the motion of your arm in three dimensions and in real-time. As you slice,



swing, or swoop through the air, your animated character on the TV screen swings the corresponding baseball bat, tennis racquet, fishing rod and so on.

Not only is it a lot of fun, but it also doubles as a great workout routine. The Wii's accessible form is proof that a great design ought to follow a clear and well thought out function.

LG AN110 Digital Projector

The LG AN110 is a digital projector that gives this genre a new aesthetic appearance. The projector delivers on two fronts—it is aesthetically pleasant, so much so that it would not be out of place in the living room, and it delivers a low profile, allowing it to be integrated with furniture or hung on walls. The mirror finish of the acrylic front panel along with fret-work-patterns is designed to reduce fingerprint marks and dust collection. It may be wall-mounted, set up freely on its own stand or simply be placed on a desktop. The automatic lens door, the ventilator, the auto focus as well as the zoom are controlled via a remote, and are adjustable to fit many different viewing scenarios. At a distance of 3.2 metres, the AN110 projector provides a 100-inch HD quality screen picture.



Wacom Intuos3 Graphic Tablet

The Intuos3 successfully simulates the feel of paper in a digital garb. Intelligent key placements and ergonomics play a vital role in this tablet's design: a vertically arranged touchpad serves to scroll up and down Internet pages, or to zoom in and out under Photoshop or Painter. The tablet is suited to both right- and left-handed use due to a symmetric arrangement of keys. The cordless and battery-less pen that drives the system comes with three exchangeable tips so that only one pen can be used for a wide variety of applications. The pen holder

PANASONIC LUMIX DMC-L1 AND C1

An external flash unit offers the flexibility to bounce light off the ceiling for an even lighting of a subject, something an inbuilt flash unit does not offer. However, you might not always have an external unit handy. These cameras from Panasonic offer the best of both worlds: if you eject the built-in flash firmly, it pops up and faces forward. But if you push lightly, it pops up angled 45 degrees upward towards the ceiling. It's a great idea!



MAGSAFE POWER ADAPTER

Another design win for Apple—the MagSafe is a simple idea that solves a very real problem of accidentally dragging your laptop to the ground by tumbling over its power cord. The idea behind the design is simple—a magnet attaches the power cord to the laptop, which easily detaches and drops when yanked, without dragging the laptop along.



CANON FACE FINDER FEATURE

Several Canon cameras offer a facial-recognition feature that hunts out faces from a scene about to be shot—this is a great feature that allows the camera to better calculate for focus and exposure, while avoiding blasting their faces with a bright flash light.

